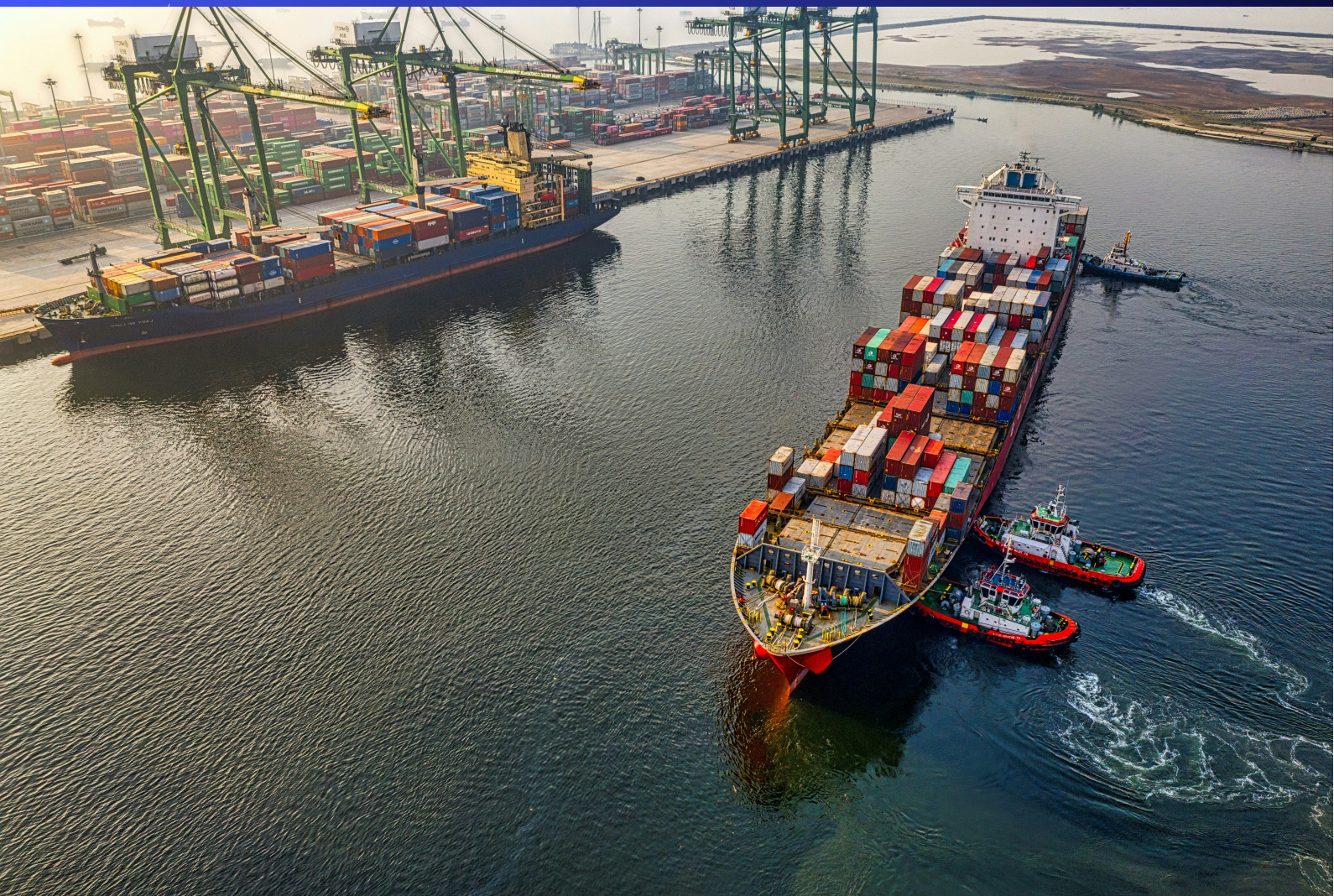




SHIPPING WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 26 MAY 2026 - 1 JUNE 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

DATA STATUS: MANUAL SCRAPER

LATEST RECORD: 1 JUN 2026

LAST UPDATED: 1 JUN 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime reporting was centred on chokepoint risk, vessel attack and advisory. Iran produced the strongest identifiable signal, with lower volumes from Singapore and UAE. Severity peaked at high.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 26 May - 1 Jun 2026	RECORDS IN WINDOW 48	HIGHEST SEVERITY High
MAIN AFFECTED CHOKEPOINT Strait of Hormuz 2 records	VESSEL ATTACKS / SEIZURES 2	PIRACY / ARMED ROBBERY 0 No qualifying piracy record in window
LATEST SIGNIFICANT INCIDENT 29 May 2026 HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman		

CHOKEPOINT / ROUTE READ

The reporting window is led by Strait of Hormuz, which carries 2 qualifying records and a highest severity of high.

Across the window, 43 records pointed specifically at transit, diversion or advisory pressure — a tighter view of what shippers actually felt across the cycle.

Watch for new naval advisories on Strait of Hormuz, any war-risk premium adjustments and operator commentary on rerouting. Those are the early indicators of escalation; commercial freight rates lag them by days.

CHOKEPOINT	RECORDS	HIGHEST SEV	LATEST	OPERATIONAL READ
Strait of Hormuz	2	HIGH	27 May 2026	Reporting was led by "Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says", with 2 qualifying records in the reporting window.
Gulf of Oman	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Arabian / Persian Gulf	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Red Sea	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Bab el-Mandeb	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Malacca Strait	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.

VESSEL THREAT AND PIRACY READ

Vessel-threat reporting across the reporting window carries 3 qualifying events, of which 2 are an attack or seizure rather than a softer boarding or approach. The lead entry is "HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman". Piracy and armed-robbery reporting is empty across the reporting window, which is unusual rather than reassuring for this geography.

Track maritime advisories, naval-force statements and any movement in war-risk or P&I premiums on affected routes. Those are the cleanest early indicators that hostile activity is firming or easing.

VESSEL ATTACKS (26 MAY - 1 JUN 2026)

DATE	ACT	TITLE	SEVERITY
29 May 2026	Attack	HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman	HIGH
27 May 2026	Attack	Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says	HIGH
30 May 2026	Threat	Threat to shipping in the Strait of Hormuz remains critical - UKMTO	LOW

PIRACY AND ARMED ROBBERY (26 MAY - 1 JUN 2026)

No piracy or armed-robbery records in this window.

COMMERCIAL IMPACT ON SHIPPING

Operational commercial pressure on shipping in the weekly window centres on port disruption, freight or insurance movement with an operational hook, and commercial-shipping disruption tied directly to vessel or cargo flows. The cycle carries 1 qualifying record on this definition. On a single weekly window this is a thin, directional signal rather than a confirmed commercial trend — treat it as a watch item, not evidence of broad commercial disruption. The lead entry is "Port congestion causing economic strain, says association" (port disruption).

Watch for follow-on schedule disruption, premium adjustments on affected routes, and any operator decisions on diversion or port-skipping. Commercial pass-through to shippers typically follows the operational signal by one to two weeks.

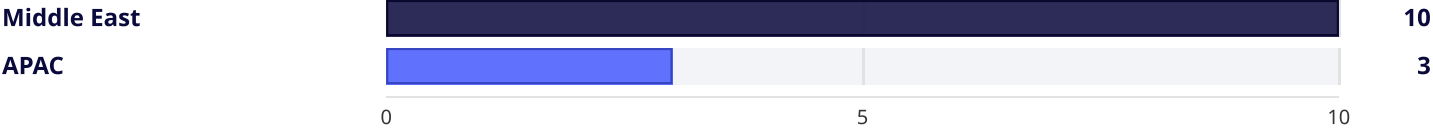
DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
28 May 2026	Port disruption	Port congestion causing economic strain, says association	MODERATE

REGIONAL AND COUNTRY VIEW

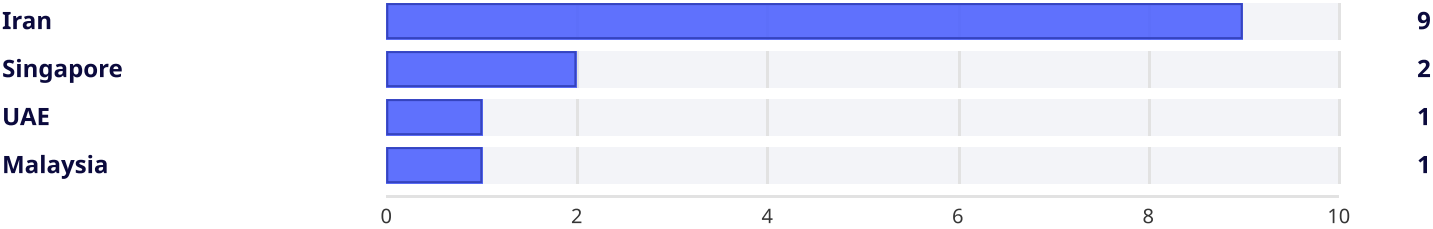
Across the weekly briefing window, Middle East carries the heavier share with 10 records against 3 for APAC. At country level the cycle is led by Iran (9), Singapore (2) and UAE (1). These country totals are indicative only: with 35 records unattributed against 13 tied to a confirmed incident country, country-level conclusions should be treated as low-confidence.

A further 35 records could not be tied to a confirmed incident country and are excluded from the country chart to avoid distortion.

RECORDS BY REGION



RECORDS BY COUNTRY



WHAT MATTERS

The cycle's centre of gravity is Strait of Hormuz, which carries 2 qualifying records. That matters for routing decisions because every additional advisory tightens transit-time variance and feeds straight into vessel scheduling and bunker planning for any operator with exposure to the region.

Hostile activity against vessels still anchors the risk picture, with 2 attack or seizure records and 0 piracy or armed-robbery entries on file across the reporting window (26 May - 1 Jun 2026). Any operator running through the affected lanes should be reviewing crew-change locations, war-risk and P&I premium exposure, and the threshold at which their advisory partners would recommend re-routing.

On the commercial side the cycle carries 1 qualifying record of port disruption, schedule slippage, war-risk or insurance movement with a clean operational anchor. That feeds directly into cargo flow planning, port-call sequencing and freight-cost pass-through to shippers.

Regionally the weekly window leaned on Middle East; country-level concentration is set out in the chart below.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Run a live review of vessel scheduling, port-call sequencing and bunker planning against the latest advisories for Strait of Hormuz.
- Size war-risk and P&I exposure now — premium adjustments typically land one to two cycles after the operational signal firms.
- Pre-position alternative routings and skip-call options on affected strings; brief commercial teams on demurrage and schedule-reliability risk.
- Re-examine crew-change locations on voyages transiting the affected lanes; shift to safer ports where supported.
- Confirm naval-escort or convoy options with advisory partners for the highest-risk strings.
- Price surcharge pass-through into cargo-flow planning — port-call disruption converts to surcharges within one to two weeks.

WATCH NEXT

- Fresh naval and maritime advisories on Strait of Hormuz: leading signal for where pressure is firming.
- UKMTO, IMB and coalition-force bulletins: move ahead of headline freight rates.
- War-risk and P&I premium movement on affected lanes: cleanest confirmation that the operational signal has firmed commercially.
- Operator decisions to divert or skip a port call: trigger schedule-reliability and demurrage review.
- Escalation in naval-escort or convoy posture: signal that advisory partners are sizing up the threat.
- Crew-change advisories and flag-state guidance updates: re-examine manning-hub plans on transiting voyages.
- Hostile-area underwriting extended to adjacent waters: clearest sign the threat perimeter is widening, not easing.

POLESTAR VIEW

Strait of Hormuz remains the dominant shipping pressure point across the reporting window (2 qualifying records), and that is where the structural risk continues to sit regardless of any individual cycle's cadence. The vessel threat picture across the window — 2 attack or seizure records and 0 piracy or armed-robbery entries — still matters. A quiet cycle in this geography is the normal pattern, not a benign trend, so it should be read as a reporting gap rather than a sustained easing.

Operators should treat the current cycle as a routing, insurance and advisory-monitoring problem rather than a broad maritime shutdown. The practical business levers sit with war-risk and P&I premium reviews, crew-change locations on voyages transiting Strait of Hormuz, and the port-call sequencing decisions that follow from fresh advisories — not with any expectation of a regional standstill.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
29 May 2026	Vessel attack	HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman	HIGH
28 May 2026	Port disruption	Port congestion causing economic strain, says association	MODERATE
27 May 2026	Vessel attack	Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says	HIGH

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